

Apple iPod Mini

The Mini Revolution

The smaller sibling of the popular iPod sports the same set of features. Available in 5 colours, the iPod Mini measures just 3.6 x 2.0 x 0.5 inches and weighs just over 100 gms. A menu button and playback options sit on the scroll wheel itself and thus enable a smooth, one-handed operation. The Select button is placed in the centre of the scroll wheel. The contrast on the backlit 1.67-inch greyscale screen is adjustable. There are 22 preset equaliser settings to choose from. With 25 minutes of skip-protection, this iPod Jr plays audio in the AAC (16 to 320 Kbps), MP3 (32 to 320 Kbps), MP3 VBR, Audible, AIFF, Apple Lossless and WAV formats. And of course, there are always songs to purchase from the iTunes Music Store. You can also view contacts, read text files, play inbuilt games and use it as an alarm clock.

Use the bundled FireWire or USB 2.0 cables and iTunes software to transfer music and other data. Also included are earphones, a power adaptor and a belt clip. Audio quality is typical IPodesque; the output classy even at maximum volume.

Transferring a GB of songs over USB 2.0 took us just 3 minutes and 27 seconds. The iPod Mini logged a battery life of 7 hours and 25 minutes, just 35 minutes short of its claimed battery life. This little wonder is bound to be an audiophile's favourite. It is also available in a choice of colours, something that the bigger-size iPods are not.



Company Apple Computer International
Price Rs 19,500
Phone 080-25550575
E-mail indiainfo@asia.apple.com
Web site www.apple.com

Freecom USBCard 16MB USB2.0

Data in the Wallet!

Wanna carry your data in the wallet? USBCard, the credit card-sized USB storage device, does just that. It measures 85.5 x 54 x 3.9 mm and weighs just 28 gm. The connector works with Windows and Mac machines. And for plug-and-play, it doesn't even ask for clumsy drivers (with Win ME & above). Data transfer is fast too—a 10 MB data transfer took just 17 seconds. Bundled software includes Password Lock, Auto Mail, Auto Run, and Secure and Zip.



Company J.S Equipments
Price Rs 2,250
Phone 022-23810713
Fax 022-23860976
E-mail jse@vsnl.com
Web site www.usbcard.com

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Hitachi Deskstar 7K400

Hitachi's 7K400 hard drive offers a staggering 400 GB of storage, which promises to hold 45 hours of HDTV broadcast, or 1,00,000 songs of 4 minutes each, or thousands of e-books in the PDF format, and lots more.

It comprises five platters, 10 heads and a solid 8 MB of buffer memory. But increased mechanical movements though could result in long term reliability issues.

We got a SATA version of the drive and it turned in good scores. The SiSoft Sandra test showed its access time as six milliseconds—quite impressive for a 400 GB drive. A GB of file transfers across partitions logged an average time of around a minute for sequential and random files.



Company Cyberstar
Price Rs 25,000
Phone 011-26438216
E-mail anil@cyberstarin.net
Web site www.hitachigst.com

PixelView PlayTV Box3

This external TV-tuner box operates without a PC. You can, however, connect a



PC to the monitor via this box and switch between TV programs and PC output. The box also allows the picture in picture mode. Use its remote to power it on or off, as well as play around with its volume, channels, etc., the controls for which are also present on the box itself.

PlayTV's output may not be as good as the Pinnacle Pro card, but is decent enough and allows full screen viewing (SXGA - 1280 x 1024 @ 75 Hz).

The kit comes with all the necessary cables, a power adapter, and batteries for the remote.

Company Rashi Peripherals
Price Rs 5,400
Phone 022-28260258
E-mail ho@rptechindia.com
Web site www.prolink.com.tw

Compex UE202-B USB Network Adapter

This tiny USB 1.1 adapter is for those stuck with old laptops equipped with defunct LAN hardware, or without Ethernet ports. It is also ideal for use with desktops that do not have a network card installed. Although it promises a speed of 100 Mbps, the USB 1.1 interface limits the throughput to just 12 Mbps.



Company Rashi Peripherals
Price Rs 1,000
Phone 022-28260258
E-mail ho@rptechindia.com
Web site www.compex.com.sg